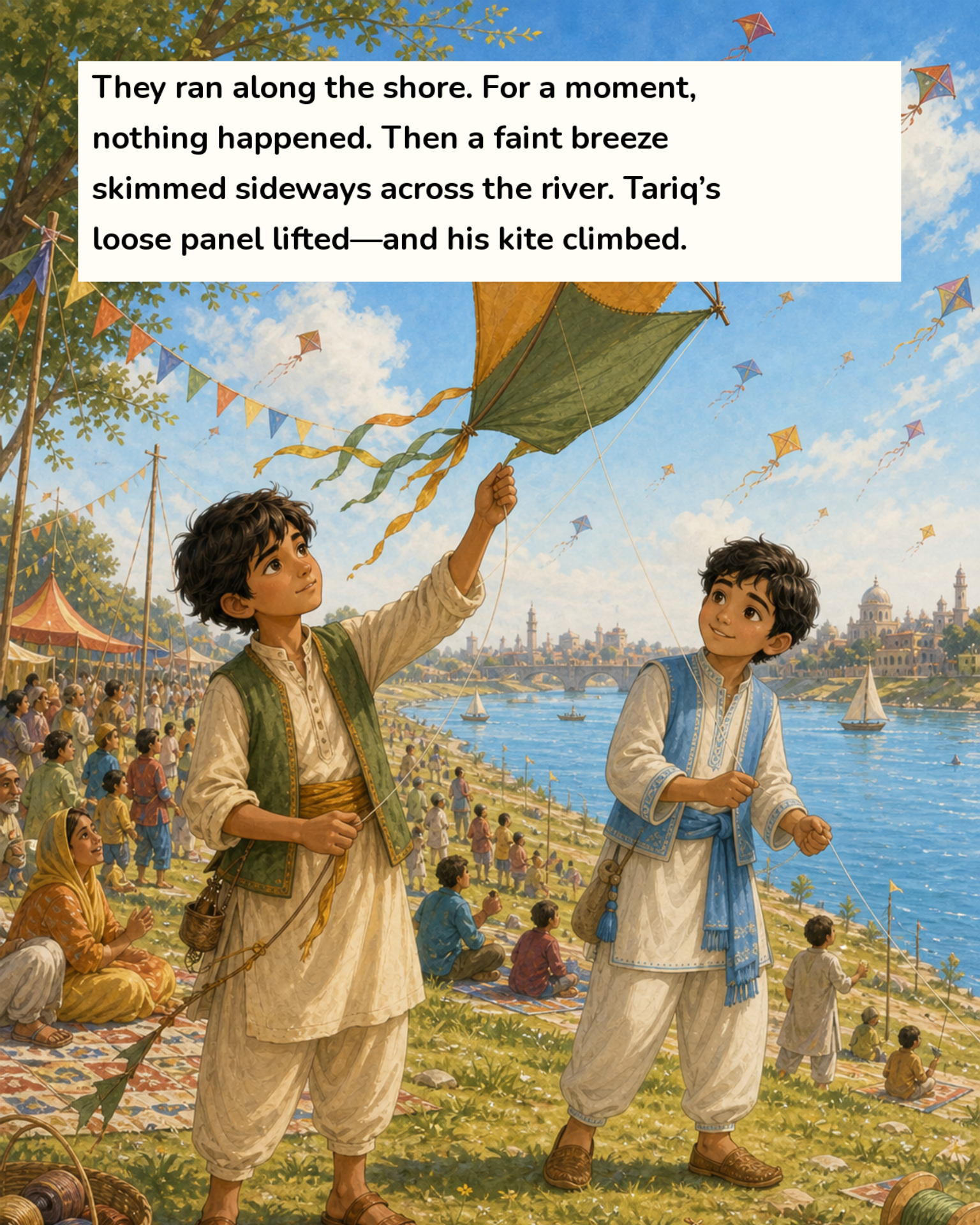
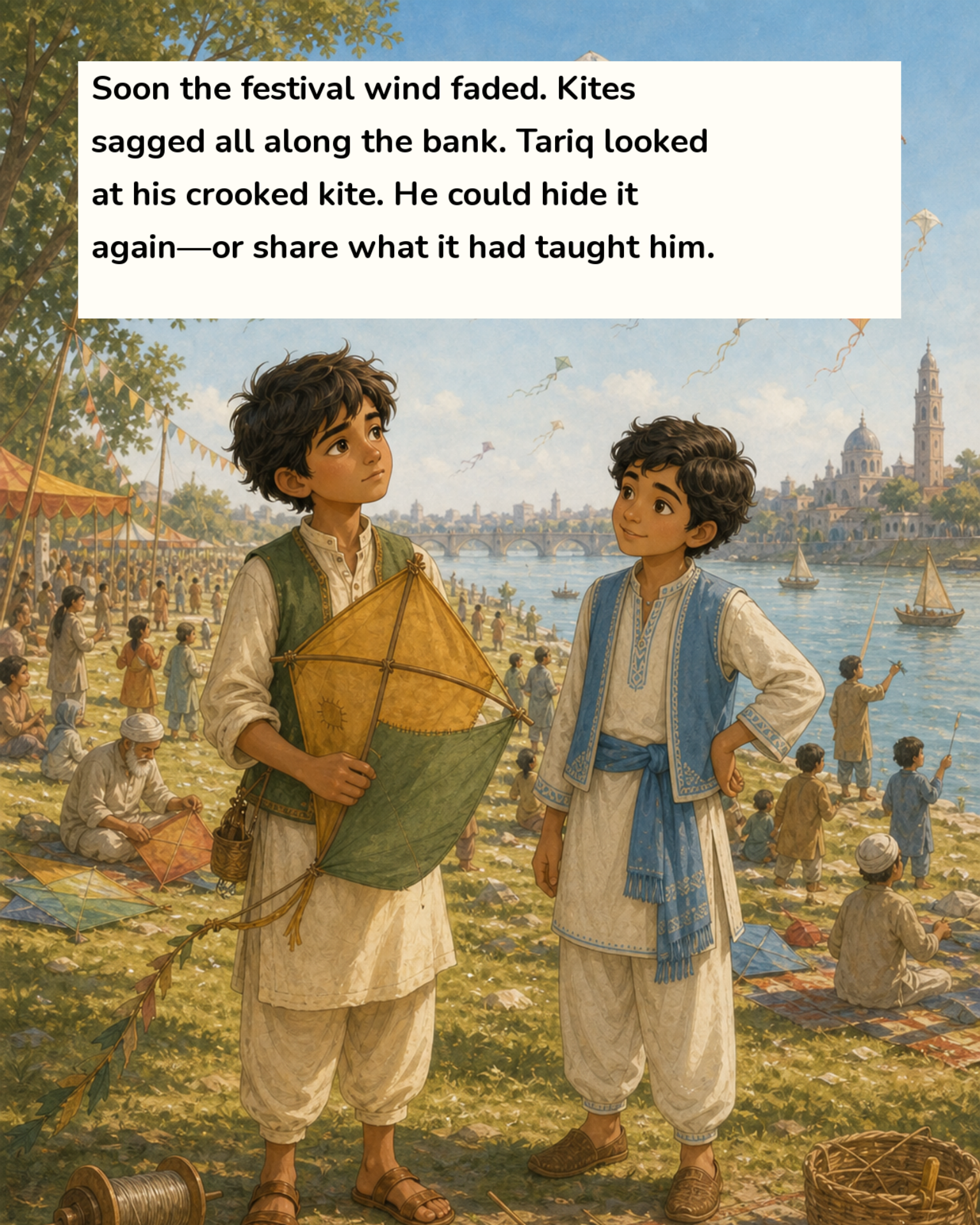
Tariq’s Crooked Kite

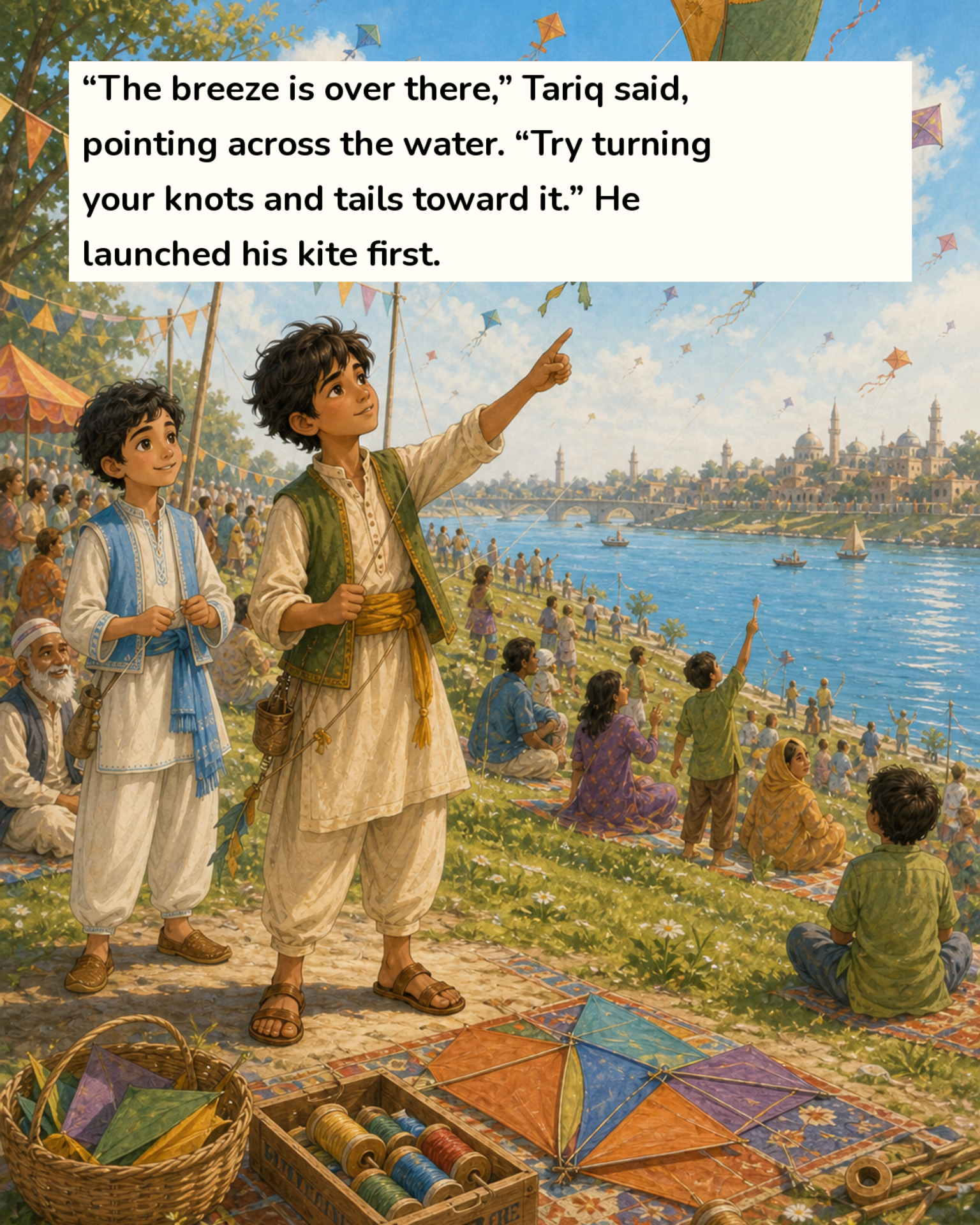
Before the riverside festival, Tariq made a kite unlike any he had seen. Its frame leaned one way, and one curved panel hung loose.

Tariq turned the kite toward the light. “Crooked,” he murmured. What if everyone laughed? He slid it behind his work table.

At the festival, a new friend spotted the hidden kite. “It looks as if it wants to try something,” they said. “Will you test it with me?”


They ran along the shore. For a moment, nothing happened. Then a faint breeze skimmed sideways across the river. Tariq’s loose panel lifted—and his kite climbed.


Soon the festival wind faded. Kites sagged all along the bank. Tariq looked at his crooked kite. He could hide it again—or share what it had taught him.


“The breeze is over there,” Tariq said, pointing across the water. “Try turning your knots and tails toward it.” He launched his kite first.

One by one, knots were shifted. Tails were angled. The sideways breeze found them—and kites began to rise.

Tariq’s crooked kite sailed over the river beside dozens of others. His new friend smiled nearby. Sharing something imperfect, Tariq realized, could help a whole community soar.